CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

DOULA IN THE AI ERA

Not medical, not family — the professional calm in the room where a life starts.

★ TL;DR — Around $45K median on this site's band, built from per-birth client fees after 1–6 months of training and practice. The catch: you are the business — marketing, on-call nights and income gaps included. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

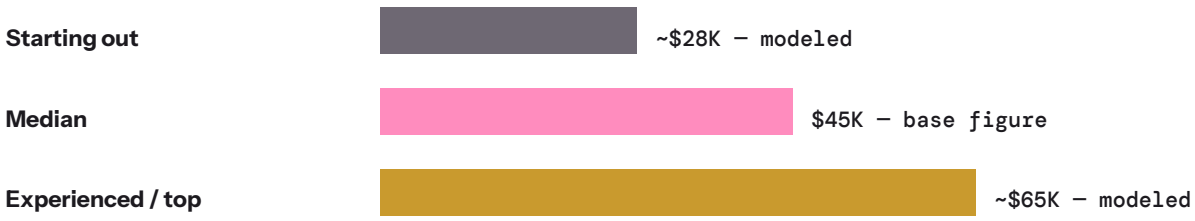
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Pure service business: your presence is the product, and clients pay per birth, not per hour.
- Entry is training-based and fast — reputation, not credentials, is the growth engine.
- Overnight on-call life is the real job description hiding under the beautiful photos.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Doula is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A DOULA ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Meet clients prenatally: birth preferences, fears, plans and backup plans

✓ Provide continuous support through labor: comfort measures, positioning, advocacy prompts

✓ Support the partner too — coaching them to be useful instead of terrified

✓ Visit postpartum: feeding support, processing the birth, practical help

Think: a Sherpa for the biggest day of someone's life — you know the terrain, they do the climb.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Essentially nothing in the room: apps help clients find doulas and handle booking and contracts. The work itself is unbothered by AI.	The entire service is human presence: reading a laboring person's state and responding. There is no automated version of being believed in at 3 a.m.

⚠ **The on-call reality breaks more doulas than the births do: you can't plan a month, a holiday or a full night's sleep around other people's due dates. Price that in — literally.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Witnessing births never becomes ordinary ✓ Your own schedule and client selection when independent ✓ Deep gratitude from clients — this work is remembered for decades	✗ On-call life: births ignore your calendar completely ✗ Income arrives in lumps between clients ✗ Physically long labors — 12, 24, sometimes more hours

Good fit? Calm in intense rooms, deeply empathetic, and entrepreneurial enough to find your own clients.
Bad fit? You need sleep regularity or get rattled by intensity, blood and nudity.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — TRAINING WORKSHOP + FIRST BIRTHS	DOOR B — DOULA AGENCY OR COLLECTIVE
Take a doula training workshop (weekend intensives plus reading and mentored births are typical), then attend births — often starting with volunteer or low-fee clients — while you build experience and testimonials.	Join an established doula agency or collective as a junior/backup doula. You get client flow and mentors; you give up a cut and some freedom. A smart way to log births fast.

Smart move: Niche down early — VBAC support, first-time parents, a specific hospital's culture. Niches get referred; generalists get scrolled past.

Where you land after: Doula → experienced doula with a full book and waitlist → childbirth educator, lactation support, or an agency of your own.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
STUDY THE	TAKE A	SHADOW AND	BUILD YOUR	TAKE FIRST	PRICE LIKE

STEP 1 — Study the local market

FREE · TODAY

- Read how working doulas near you price and package support.
- Decide birth-only, postpartum, or both — different lives entirely.

STEP 2 — Take a training workshop

WEEKS

- A reputable workshop covers labor stages, comfort measures, scope and business basics.
- Start the classic reading list the same week.

STEP 3 — Shadow and attend births

FIRST MONTHS

- Attend births as a backup or trainee with an experienced doula.
- Hospital and birth-center etiquette is learned only in the rooms.

STEP 4 — Build your tiny business

ONGOING

- Make an honest page: training, births attended, packages, backup plan.
- Referrals from midwives, nurses and past clients are the engine.

STEP 5 — Take first clients

CLIENTS 1-3

- Early clients may be low-fee; treat them like flagship work.
- Collect testimonials and permission to share birth stories.

STEP 6 — Price like a professional

MONTHS 4-6

- Set real prices and an on-call structure you can sustain.
- Burnout in doula work is a scheduling failure, not a character flaw.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: read three doulas' websites; list upcoming training workshops.

□ Days 1–30: book your training; start the reading list; join a local doula group.

□ Days 31–60: training completed or underway; shadow/mentor conversations started.

□ Days 61–90: attend first births as backup or trainee; portfolio page drafted.

□ Day 90: you're a trained doula seeking first clients — the business runway has started.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ CALM IS A PROFESSION. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.